

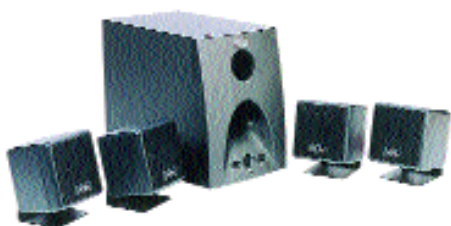
Dolby Digital-capable soundcard is quite affordable and is ideal for movies that include surround sound.

Price: Rs 2,610

Multi-channel speaker system: The next thing you need is a multi-channel speaker system that can render surround sound. The more powerful your speaker system, the more profound will be your audio experience. Multi-channel speakers can be as costly as you want them to be. However, a good place to start is with a simple four-channel satellite-subwoofer system. These speakers are priced very affordably nowadays and have adequate power for delivering a good movie-watching experience in an average-sized 15x20 feet room.

We chose the Artis S880 for its power and great overall performance at a good price. With very good results in the movie playback tests, the surround positioning and definition was great with this speaker system. It also sports good frequency response, making it very suited to music playback as well.

Price: Rs 4,000



Artis S880: Experience immersive surround sound

DVD-ROM drive: This is the component that will allow you to play back high-quality movies that contain surround sound information such as Dolby Digital, Dolby Surround and DTS. Besides, the visual quality of DVDs is far sharper because of the native resolution support of 720x480 compared to the significantly lower resolution of 320x240 supported by VCDs.

Sporting a cool slot-loading disk interface, the BenQ 1648A is a 16x DVD drive with a 48x CD read speed. It boasts of very impressive performance—with an average



BenQ 1648A: Great for movies

access speed of 85 ms and a data transfer speed of over 21 MBps when reading DVDs, this drive will get you through the most demanding applications. It has support for a wide array of DVD standards, ensuring that you won't have a problem reading even DVD-R disks.

Price: Rs 3,300

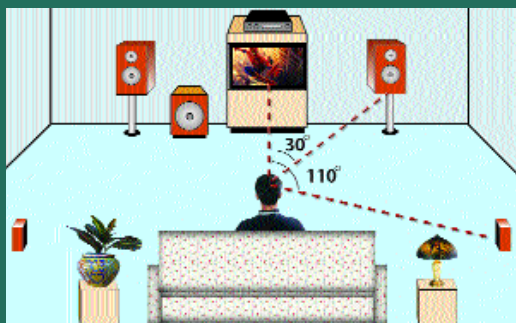
19-inch monitor (optional): If your budget allows it, consider getting a large-screen monitor. This would make your home theatre experience complete.

The Samsung 995DF flat-screen 19-inch monitor is capable of a flicker-free resolution of up to 1280x1024 at 80 Hz.

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Optimum Speaker Placement for a Conventional Home Theatre System

To get the best out of your home theatre system, place the left and right speakers along the width of your room. From where you are going to be sitting, the front speakers should be approximately 60 degrees apart from each other with the listener at



the reference central position. The rear speakers should form a 110 degree angle from this reference position. For optimum effect, the four speakers should be kept at or slightly above ear level. You can place the subwoofer anywhere. If you find that the bass in your system is a little low, place the subwoofer facing a wall, preferably in the corner of the room. If the surround sound channels are too faint, 'toe-in' the surround speakers such that they point toward the listener. Conversely, if they are too prominent, place them facing the wall as this helps disperse the sound from the rear channels, resulting in a more enveloping effect.